

CASTE SYSTEM IN INDIA — Part 3

Paper 2 • Chapter 3.2 • Sarathi IAS Foundation • Handout 3

CASTE SYSTEM — PART 3

7 Theories of Origin

Traditional • Brahmanical • Racial • Occupational • Ketkar • Senart • Hutton

Dominant Caste (Srinivas)

Caste Mobility

Criteria • Examples • Relevance • Criticism

5 Types • 6 Factors • Downward Mobility

1. THEORIES OF ORIGIN OF CASTE

Many theories explain caste's origin but **none gained universal acceptance**. The caste system is a **complex, multifaceted social phenomenon** shaped by religious, cultural, economic & political influences.

1.1 Traditional Theory

TRADITIONAL THEORY — CASTE BY DIVINE ORDINANCE

Core Idea	Hindu society = supernatural-centred society . Caste established by divine ordinance or divine approval.
Two Versions	(a) Mythical: Four varnas = four castes, emerged from different parts of Brahma's body . Birth in a caste determined by karma of previous incarnation . (b) Metaphysical: Each caste has a separate function determined by nature (swabhav) and qualities (guna) . E.g., born to rule → Kshatriya.

Criticism (2 reasons):

1. Considers caste a **natural phenomenon**
2. Equates four varnas with four castes

M.N. Srinivas

"The idea of caste as a four-fold division of society represents a **gross oversimplification of facts**. The **real unit** of the caste system is **jati**."

1.2 Brahmanical Theory

BRAHMANICAL THEORY — ABBE DUBOIS

Core Idea	Caste = ingenious device made by Brahmins for Brahmins
Mechanism	Brahmins imposed restrictions on eating, drinking, marriage & social relations with non-Brahmins to preserve purity
Privilege	Gave themselves high status & special privileges in Brahmana texts; declared all others inferior
Support	Ghurye agrees — caste-society resulted from Brahmanic civilization excluding aborigines & Sudras from religious & social communion

Criticism — Hutton argues against:

1. If accepted, caste must have originated when **Brahmins had political power** — but caste **did not originate so late**

1.3 Racial Theory

RACIAL THEORY — RISLEY

Core Idea	Clash of cultures & contact of races crystallised castes in India
Aryans vs Locals	Migrant Aryans had ideas of ceremonial purity , considered original inhabitants inferior
Marriage rules	Aryans: patrilineal ; conquered people: matrilineal . Aryans married aboriginal daughters but refused to give their own (hypergamy)

Chandalas	Children of "irregular unions" assigned lowest position = chandalas
Key Argument	Origin of "half-breeds" + feeling of racial superiority → origin of caste

Risley's 6 Processes of Caste Formation

#	PROCESS	HOW NEW CASTES FORM
1	Change in occupation	Adopting new occupation → sub-division becomes distinct caste
2	Migration	Migrated section cut off from parental caste → develops as new caste
3	Change in customs	Discarding old customs & adopting new practices → new caste
4	Preservation of old traditions	Section preserves old traces , takes new name to separate from reformers
5	Hinduisation	Tribe becomes "Hinduised" & takes caste name. E.g., Maria Gonds (MP), Rajbanshis (Bengal)
6	Role of religious enthusiasts	Preacher's followers form a sect → develops as new caste

Criticism: If racial theory is correct, caste **should not be confined to India** but found in **all societies** that faced racial conquests. Is caste uniquely Indian?

1.4 Occupational Theory

OCCUPATIONAL THEORY — NESFIELD

Core Idea	Caste origin has nothing to do with race or religion — it is mainly due to functions/occupations
Mechanism	Technical skill passed hereditarily from generation to generation → " occupational guilds " formed → later known as castes
Hierarchy	Result of feeling of superiority/inferiority of occupations

Criticism —  **D.N. Majumdar:**

Status of castes depends **not on superiority/inferiority of occupation** but upon the **degree of purity of blood** and extent of **isolation** maintained by groups.

1.5 Ketkar's Theory

KETKAR'S THEORY — CASTES FROM TRIBES

Core Idea	Origin of castes from early tribes — each tribe group was endogamous & hostile to other tribes
Key claim	Castes are " developed tribes " or " converted groups "

Criticism:

- Accepting this would mean caste evolved **not by Aryans but by native Dravidians/aborigines**
- Caste did **not exist in pre-Vedic period**; evolved only in **post-Vedic period** — tribals cannot be held responsible

1.6 Senart's Theory

SENART'S THEORY — ARYAN SOURCES (1930)

Core Idea	Origin of caste traced to Aryan sources
Comparison	Indians, Greeks & Romans = all Aryans . Similar structures: India: family, gotra , caste • Rome: gens, curia , tribe • Greece: family, phratry , phyle
Councils	Just as caste panchayats exist in India with sarpanch , similar councils exist in Rome & Greece
Conclusion	Caste = natural development of ancient Aryan institutions

Criticism —  **Dahlmann:**

Origin of caste **cannot be explained only in terms of certain elements**. Such a complex institution must be the result of **multiple forces**.

1.7 Hutton's Theory of Mana

HUTTON'S THEORY OF MANA (1961)

Core Idea	Caste formation based on " primitive " conception of mana
-----------	---

What is Mana?	A mysterious impersonal power attached to individuals, objects & places
Taboos	Imposed on commensality, inter-marriage & interaction to save members from mana of other tribes
Food restrictions	Based on belief that food & contacts may be infected with dangerous mana
Evidence	Study of Nagas (1923-24) — villagers refused to accept presents or money from strangers for fear of mana

Criticism — **D.N. Majumdar (1952):**
Tribes in **other societies also believe in mana** but we do **not find a caste system there**.

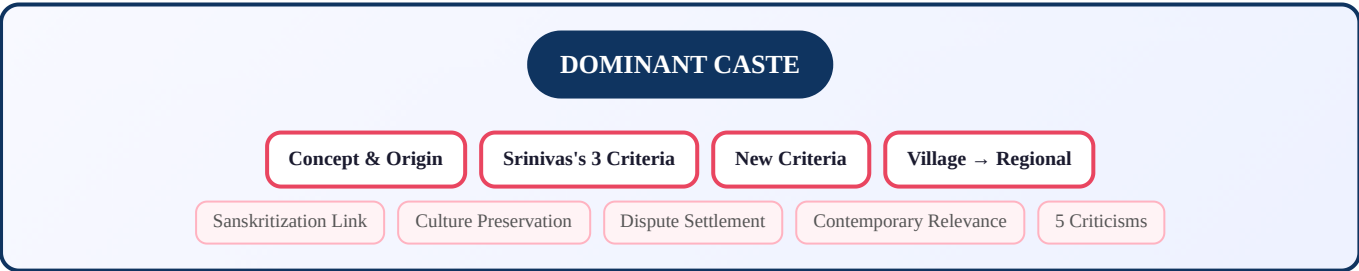
Hutton himself considers caste as outcome of interaction of **geographical, social, political, religious & economic factors** — not mana alone.

CONCLUSION — Multifactor Theory:
Scholars like **S.C. Roy** & **R.K. Mukherjee** supported the **Multifactor Theory** — several factors working together over time led to the emergence of the Indian caste system. Its origins cannot be traced to a single factor but are the outcome of a **long and layered historical process**.

Quick Comparison — All 7 Theories

THEORY	SCHOLAR	CASTE ORIGINATED FROM...	CRITICISM BY
Traditional	Vedic texts	Divine ordinance / Brahma's body / Karma	M.N. Srinivas
Brahmanical	Abbe Dubois, Ghurye	Brahmins' device for purity & privilege	Hutton
Racial	Risley	Clash of Aryan & aboriginal races	Not unique to India
Occupational	Nesfield	Hereditary occupational guilds	D.N. Majumdar
Ketkar	Ketkar	Early endogamous tribes	Pre-Vedic tribes ≠ caste
Senart	Senart	Aryan institutional development	Dahlmann
Hutton (Mana)	Hutton	Fear of mana → taboos → caste	D.N. Majumdar
Multifactor Theory: S.C. Roy & R.K. Mukherjee — caste = complex product of multiple forces			

2. DOMINANT CASTE (M.N. Srinivas)



M.N. Srinivas — "Dominant Caste in Rampura" (path-breaking research paper)
Dominant Caste = castes with **large population + land rights** (granted by post-Independence land reforms). Land reforms took away rights from "absentee landlords" (upper castes who only collected rent).

2.1 Srinivas's Original 3 Criteria

#	CRITERION	HOW IT CREATES DOMINANCE
1	Sizable cultivable land	Economic resources → control over agricultural production → translates into political & social power
2	Considerable numerical strength	Large voting bloc → ability to mobilise resources & influence public opinion
3	High place in local caste hierarchy	Social prestige & cultural capital → economic & political power + control over social norms & values

2.2 New/Changed Criteria (Post-Independence)

Mere ownership of land, numerical strength & ritual hierarchy are **no longer the only factors**. New features have emerged:

NEW CRITERION	HOW IT CONTRIBUTES
Political Clout	Control decision-making & access to resources → economic & social power
Western Education	Skills & knowledge valued in modern society → economic opportunities & social mobility
Jobs in Administration	Access to positions of power — law enforcement, public policy, governance

Village Level → Regional Level Dominance: Due to expansion of transport & communication, village-level dominance is no longer enough. **Regional level dominance** is now the better criterion. (Criteria: Numerical Strength + Political Clout + Land Ownership + Education + Jobs in Administration)

2.3 Examples of Dominant Castes (by Region)

REGION	DOMINANT CASTE(S)
Mysore villages	Lingayat & Okkaliga
Andhra Pradesh	Reddy & Kamma
Tamil Nadu	Gounder, Padayachi & Mudaliar
Kerala	Nair
Maharashtra	Maratha
Gujarat	Patidar
Northern India	Rajput, Jat, Giyar & Ahir

2.4 Dominant Caste & Sanskritization

Sanskritization for lower castes is NOT always Brahmins — it is the **Dominant Caste** that lower castes try to emulate to climb up the social ladder.

Case Study: Thakur Landlords (Eastern UP)

The dominant **Thakur landlords** make Brahmins cook food except their *kulguru* (family priest). Lower castes emulate Thakurs, not Brahmins.

Case Study: Jat Landlords (Punjab)

Jat landlords view **Brahmins as their servants**. Lower castes emulate Jats in this context.

2.5 Other Roles of Dominant Caste

ROLE	DESCRIPTION
Culture Preservation	Keeps distance from others in village & region. Acts as protector & watchdog of culture . Sets norms of behaviour — violations dealt with severely.
Dispute Settlement	Settles disputes through traditional village & caste councils — both inter-caste & intra-caste disputes.

2.6 Contemporary Relevance / Significance

#	DIMENSION	DETAILS & EXAMPLES
1	Political Mobilisation & Electoral Power	With adult franchise & Panchayati Raj, numerical strength = central to politics. Case: <i>Yadavs in Bihar & UP</i> — leaders like Lalu Prasad Yadav, Mulayam Singh Yadav. 🔪 Yogendra Yadav — dominant OBC castes act as " vote banks " shaping regional parties (RJD, SP).
2	Cultural Hegemony & Emulation	Dominant castes remain cultural models for lower castes. Sanskritization targets lifestyle of dominant regional groups, not just Brahmins . Case: <i>Jats in Punjab / Thakurs in UP</i> emulated by lower castes in rituals, food, marriage customs.
3	Erosion & Contestation	Dominance challenged by SC/ST assertion, reservations & social movements . Case: Dalit movements in Maharashtra (Ambedkarite mobilisation); BSP rise in UP disrupted Maratha & Thakur dominance. Still, dominant castes adapt by forming alliances or repositioning in party politics.
4	Changing Basis — Beyond Land	Andre Beteille (2003) — dominance no longer tied only to land; education, bureaucracy & political networks are crucial. Case: <i>Lingayats in Karnataka, Reddys in AP</i> dominate through educational institutions & political representation, not just agriculture.

2.7 Criticism / Limitations of Dominant Caste

#	CRITICISM	SCHOLAR	DETAILS
1	Dominant Individuals vs Dominant Caste	 S.C. Dube & Peter Gardner	Dominance often held by individuals or factions within a caste, not the caste as a whole. Dominant individuals exploit weaker members of their own caste too. Srinivas's Response: "Dominant individuals & dominant factions owe their dominance to the fact that they are part of the dominant caste. "
2	Changing Basis of Dominance	 D.N. Majumdar	Study of Mohana village (UP, 1958) : Brahmins & Thakurs dominant due to <i>zamindari</i> . After abolition, Thakur dominance weakened (retained some power through moneylending). Dominance based on land is NOT permanent.
3	Numerical Strength not Decisive	 D.N. Majumdar	In many villages, Scheduled Castes (Lodha, Pasi in UP) may be numerically largest but authority rests with few upper-caste landlord families .
4	Political Dominance via Numbers	 Andre Beteille & Yogendra Singh	Under adult suffrage , numerical strength became crucial for political dominance , especially for SCs & STs with reserved seats .

Conclusion: The concept of dominant caste (M.N. Srinivas) remains **highly relevant** for understanding **social hierarchies & power dynamics** in Indian society. It helps study **caste-based social stratification** and the role of caste in shaping **political & economic relationships** in villages. Dominant castes continue to **control local politics & hold economic power**, while lower castes face **discrimination & marginalisation**.

3. CASTE MOBILITY

CASTE MOBILITY

Definition

5 Types of Upward Mobility

6 Factors Enabling Mobility

5 Types of Downward Mobility

Warfare • Serving Rulers • Census • Sanskritization/Westernization • Politics

Caste mobility = process where **lower castes try to raise their social status** in the hierarchy, and the **caste as a group attempts mobility** by gaining political power or through **politicisation of castes**. It is **NOT a new phenomenon** — prevalent for many centuries.

 **Silverberg**

Social mobility in India through **renunciation** — lower castes tried to perform acts of **sannyasins** to increase social value and escape deprivation.

 **M.N. Srinivas**

Through his studies of **Sanskritization & Westernization**, explained caste mobility.

3.1 Five Types of Caste Mobility (Upward)

#	TYPE	SCHOLAR	MECHANISM & EXAMPLE
1	Mobility through Warfare	 Pauline Kolenda  M.N. Srinivas	Most effective way = acquisition of territory through conquest or peaceful occupancy of empty land . Example: Shivaji (Maratha King, Sudra varna) — overthrew Mughal rule, established Maratha empire, went through religious rites of transition into Kshatriyahood . Along with Shivaji, the Marathas as a whole became Kshatriyas .
2	Mobility through Serving Rulers	—	Jatis serving Hindu or non-Hindu castes acquired higher Varna rank . Example: Patidars of Gujarat (Shudra Varna) supported Maratha descendants of Shivaji (Gaekwads) who ruled central Gujarat. Gradually claimed Kshatriya status & established their own regimes.
3	Mobility through Census Commissioners	Herbert Risley (Census Commissioner)	During census (1891-1931), tried to rank all castes. Hundreds of jatis tried to get ranked high by claiming Varna titles . Example: Kurmi cultivators of Bengal → wanted to be called Kurmi Kshatriyas; Teli (oil pressers) → wanted to be called Vaishyas.
4	Mobility through Sanskritization & Westernization	M.N. Srinivas (1952)	Sanskritization : Low caste rises in a generation or two by adopting Vegetarianism & Teetotalism , taking over rituals, customs, rites & beliefs of Brahmins, giving up practices considered impure . Westernization : Emulating western cultures — adopting ideology, values, institutions, technology. Key feature: emphasis on technology & rationalism .
5	Mobility by Use of Politics	 Eleanor Zelliot  Rajni Kothari & Rushikesh Maru	Castes use politics to secure governmental benefits & representation in legislative bodies . Example 1: Mahars of Maharashtra — military service → claimed higher position + exposure to Western culture. Example 2 (Zelliot): Reddys (AP), Kammas (AP) — political mobility. Example 3 (Kothari & Maru): Middle & lower castes in Gujarat formed organisations in 1940s-50s for political power . After winning elections against Congress, accepted into Kshatriya fold.

3.2 Six Factors Responsible for (Upward) Caste Mobility

#	FACTOR	SCHOLAR	DETAILS
1	Decline of Jajmani System	—	Traditional system tied lower castes to hereditary occupations & ritual services . Decline due to monetisation, market integration & urban migration → service castes broke free → new occupations → upward mobility.
2	Emergence of Modern Occupations	Sharma (1974)	New occupational avenues (teaching, administration, technical professions) opened after colonial rule. Not linked to caste background → lower & middle castes improved social status.
3	Decline of Untouchability & Purity-Pollution	Pauline Kolenda (1986)	Caste hierarchies maintained by strict purity-pollution notions . Decline due to social reform movements, urbanisation & state laws → Dalits accessed education, employment & public spaces → upward mobility.
4	Education	—	Modern education → pathway to respected professions, government jobs & leadership . Also fostered social awareness to challenge caste inequalities.

5	State Policy of Protective Discrimination	—	Reservation in education, government jobs & political representation for SCs, STs & OBCs. Acted as structural lever for change .
6	Social Movements	—	Led by Jyotiba Phule, Periyar, B.R. Ambedkar — mobilised oppressed communities. Dalit movements, backward caste mobilisations & regional caste associations pushed for rights, dignity & recognition.

3.3 Downward Caste Mobility

#	TYPE	DETAILS & CASE STUDIES
1	Abolition of Zamindari & Jagirdari (Rajasthan)	Land reforms → Rajputs, Brahmins & Jats (former Zamindars) fell into economic decline. Some became manual & agricultural labourers . Case: Sharma (1968) — Rajasthan villages: ex-Zamindars working alongside Dalits in famine relief works = drastic downward mobility.
2	Green Revolution & Agrarian Capitalism	Mechanisation & capitalist farming → pauperisation of small peasants & tenants ; rich tenants rose as capitalist farmers. Scholar: Saith & Tankha (1972) — middle & lower peasants experienced downward mobility despite technological progress.
3	Domain-specific Decline among Service Castes	Barbers — gave up polluting tasks (cleaning plates) → lost patronage, split into sub-groups, economic hardship. Balais (leather workers) — discarded leather work for ritual status → ended up as casual labourers , lost livelihood.
4	Failed Upward Mobility of Scheduled Castes	Regars (leather workers) in Rajasthan, Haryana & Western UP attempted to renounce leather work (1971-72) . Faced harassment from dominant Jats & severe livelihood insecurity → forced to revert to traditional occupation within months.
5	Withdrawal of Status Respect (Jagirdars)	Post-abolition: Jagirdars in Rajasthan lost land AND political clout. Some withdrew from Panchayat politics due to humiliation of competing with lower castes → decline in both social & political domains.

Conclusion: Caste mobility is a **two-way process shaped by history, economy, politics & culture**. The caste system, though rigid, has **never been completely static**. Communities moved upward through warfare, service to rulers, Sanskritisation, census claims & politics. Modern factors (education, social movements, state policies) further enabled mobility. At the same time, structural changes like **land reforms & Green Revolution pushed some castes downward**. Making it central to understanding Indian society.

HANDWRITTEN ANNOTATIONS INDEX

#	ANNOTATION	CONTEXT	SECTION
1	 Hutton	Criticised Brahmanical Theory — caste didn't originate when Brahmins had political power	Theories of Origin
2	 D.N. Majumdar	Criticised Nesfield (Occupational Theory) — status depends on purity of blood, not occupation	Theories of Origin
3	 Dahlmann	Criticised Senart's Theory — caste origin needs multiple forces, not just Aryan elements	Theories of Origin
4	 D.N. Majumdar (1952)	Criticised Hutton's Mana theory — other societies have mana but no caste	Theories of Origin
5	 S.C. Roy & R.K. Mukherjee	Supported Multifactor Theory of caste origin	Theories of Origin
6	 Yogendra Yadav	Dominant OBC castes act as "vote banks" shaping regional parties	Dominant Caste
7	 S.C. Dube & Peter Gardner	Dominance is by individuals/factions, not entire caste	Dominant Caste — Criticism
8	 D.N. Majumdar	Mohana village study (UP, 1958) — dominance shifts with zamindari abolition	Dominant Caste — Criticism
9	 Andre Beteille & Yogendra Singh	Numerical strength crucial for political dominance under adult suffrage	Dominant Caste — Criticism
10	 Silverberg	Social mobility through renunciation (sannyasins)	Caste Mobility
11	 M.N. Srinivas	Sanskritization & Westernization; Shivaji example of mobility through warfare	Caste Mobility
12	 Pauline Kolenda	Caste mobility through warfare — conquest or peaceful occupancy	Caste Mobility
13	 Eleanor Zelliot	Mobility by politics — securing government benefits & representation	Caste Mobility

14	 Rajni Kothari & Rushikesh Maru	Gujarat lower castes → political organisations (1940s-50s) → Kshatriya status	Caste Mobility
----	---	---	----------------

QUICK-REVISION CHEAT SHEET

TOPIC	MAIN POINTS (KEYWORDS)	KEY SCHOLARS	EXAMPLES	KEY CASE STUDIES
Traditional Theory	Divine ordinance, Brahma's body, Karma, Swabhav/Guna, Mythical vs Metaphysical	M.N. Srinivas (critic)	Born to rule → Kshatriya	—
Brahmanical Theory	Device by Brahmins, purity, restrictions on eating/marriage, special privileges	Abbe Dubois, Ghurye, Hutton (critic)	Brahmana texts giving Brahmin superiority	—
Racial Theory	Clash of races, Aryan purity, patrilineal vs matrilineal, chandalas, 6 processes of caste formation	Risley	Maria Gonds (MP), Rajbanshis (Bengal) — Hinduisation	—
Occupational Theory	Occupational guilds, hereditary skills, hierarchy = superiority of occupations	Nesfield, D.N. Majumdar (critic)	—	—
Ketkar's Theory	Early endogamous tribes, hostile, developed tribes = castes	Ketkar	—	Pre-Vedic tribes ≠ caste creators
Senart's Theory	Aryan sources, India-Rome-Greece parallel, family/gotra/caste = gens/curia/tribe	Senart, Dahlmann (critic)	Panchayat/Sarpanch parallels	—
Hutton's Mana Theory	Mana = mysterious impersonal power, taboos on commensality/marriage, food infected with mana	Hutton, D.N. Majumdar (critic)	—	Nagas (1923-24) refusing gifts from strangers
Multifactor Theory	Multiple forces: religious, cultural, economic, political → long historical process	S.C. Roy, R.K. Mukherjee	—	—
Dominant Caste	Land + numbers + ritual rank; NEW: political clout, education, admin jobs; village → regional; sanskritization link; culture watchdog; dispute settler	M.N. Srinivas, Andre Beteille (2003), Yogendra Yadav, S.C. Dube, Peter Gardner, D.N. Majumdar, Yogendra Singh	Lingayat/Okkaliga (Mysore), Reddy/Kamma (AP), Maratha (MH), Patidar (GJ), Jat/Rajput (North)	Rampura (Srinivas), Thakur landlords (Eastern UP), Jat landlords (Punjab), Mohana village UP (Majumdar 1958), Yadavs in Bihar/UP, BSP rise in UP, Dalit movements MH
Caste Mobility — Upward	5 types: warfare, serving rulers, census, Sanskritization/Westernization, politics; NOT new phenomenon; group mobility + politicisation	Silverberg, M.N. Srinivas, Pauline Kolenda, Herbert Risley, Eleanor Zelliot, Rajni Kothari, Rushikesh Maru	Shivaji (Sudra → Kshatriya), Patidars of Gujarat, Kurmi Kshatriyas, Teli → Vaishyas, Mahars of Maharashtra	Gujarat castes 1940s-50s political orgs → Kshatriya; Reddys & Kammass political mobility
Caste Mobility — Factors	6 factors: Jajmani decline, modern occupations, untouchability decline, education, reservation, social movements	Sharma (1974), Pauline Kolenda (1986), Jyotiba Phule, Periyar, B.R. Ambedkar	—	—
Downward Mobility	Zamindari abolition, Green Revolution pauperisation, service caste decline, failed SC mobility, Jagirdar withdrawal	Sharma (1968), Saith & Tankha (1972)	Barbers, Balais (leather), Regars (leather)	Rajasthan ex-Zamindars in famine relief; Regars (1971-72) forced back to leather; Jagirdars withdrawing from Panchayats

BUILDING BLOCKS — Most Important Scholars & Examples by Topic

TOPIC / PYQ THEME	MUST-USE SCHOLARS	MUST-USE EXAMPLES / CASE STUDIES	KEY CONCEPTS TO DROP
Theories of Origin of Caste HIGH FREQ	Risley (Racial), Nesfield (Occupational), Hutton (Mana), Abbe Dubois (Brahmanical), Ghurye, Senart, Ketkar, M.N. Srinivas (jati ≠ varna), D.N. Majumdar (critic), Dahlmann (critic), S.C. Roy & R.K. Mukherjee (Multifactor)	Maria Gonds & Rajbanshis (Hinduisation), Nagas 1923-24 (Mana), India-Rome-Greece parallel (Senart)	Supernatural-centred society, gross oversimplification, jati as real unit, purity of blood, occupational guilds, endogamous tribes, mana, multifactor approach
Dominant Caste VERY HIGH FREQ	M.N. Srinivas (concept + Rampura), Andre Beteille (2003 — beyond land), Yogendra Yadav (vote banks), S.C. Dube & Peter Gardner (individuals vs caste), D.N. Majumdar (Mohana village), Yogendra Singh (numerical strength)	Rampura study, Thakur landlords (UP), Jat landlords (Punjab), Yadavs in Bihar/UP (Lalu, Mulayam), BSP rise (UP), Lingayats (Karnataka), Reddys (AP), Mohana village 1958	Absentee landlords, regional level dominance, culture watchdog, vote banks, caste-based social stratification, sanskritization targets dominant caste not just Brahmins
Caste Mobility HIGH FREQ	Silverberg (renunciation), M.N. Srinivas (Sanskritization/Westernization), Pauline Kolenda (warfare + purity-pollution 1986), Herbert Risley (census), Eleanor Zelliot (politics), Rajni Kothari & Rushikesh Maru (Gujarat), Sharma (1974 occupations; 1968 Rajasthan), Saith & Tankha (1972)	Shivaji Sudra → Kshatriya, Patidars of Gujarat, Kurmi Kshatriyas, Mahars of Maharashtra, Gujarat castes 1940s-50s, Regars 1971-72, Rajasthan ex-Zamindars, Barbers & Balais decline	Politicisation of castes, vegetarianism & teetotalism, technology & rationalism, two-way process, structural lever, protective discrimination, pauperisation
Cross-Cutting: Caste & Politics MEDIUM	Yogendra Yadav, Rajni Kothari, Eleanor Zelliot, Srinivas, Ambedkar	Yadavs (RJD/SP), Mahars (MH), Reddys/Kammass (AP), BSP in UP, Gujarat organisations	Vote banks, caste associations, political mobilisation, adult franchise, Panchayati Raj, reserved seats
Cross-Cutting: Caste & Social Change MEDIUM	Srinivas (Sanskritization/Westernization/Dominant Caste), Kolenda, Phule, Periyar, Ambedkar	Thakurs emulated in UP, Jats emulated in Punjab, Dalit movements in MH, land reform impacts	Emulation, cultural hegemony, erosion & contestation, social movements as mobility enablers, reservation as structural change

